

Usability Study Report Orbit

Author: Alex Perkins, Nathalie (Nat) Cabrera

Recordings URL: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_6n5IwsDb1E&feature=youtu.be

Application description

Orbit is a full-stack local events application. Users can browse a board of upcoming community events (“posts”), view event details, mark themselves as attending (“I Am In”), see who else is attending, comment on an event, and create their own event listings. Registered users can edit or delete the events they created and remove their own comments. The application is built with React on the frontend and Node/Express with MongoDB on the backend, and is deployed on a public server.

Users and Target Audience Members

Persona 1: The Organizer

1. A community member (e.g. a hobby group lead, student club officer, or neighbor organizing a meetup) who wants an easy way to post a local event, without setting up a full Meetup/Eventbrite listing.
2. Comfortable with basic web forms; not necessarily technical. Primary goal: post an event quickly and see who's coming.

Persona 2: The Attendee

3. A local person browsing for something to do like a run club, a board game night and wants to quickly scan what's happening nearby, RSVP, and ask a quick question in the comments before deciding to go.
4. Casual user, likely on a phone, low patience for friction or unclear navigation.

Persona 3: New Person in Town

5. A person who just moved to town wants to find events in the area
6. Is unsure about the app but wants to give it a try to see if they can make friends.

Data

The application stores and displays data such as:

- event posts (title, description, category, date, time, and creator)
- comments (text and author, tied to a post)
- attendance records / meetups (which users have joined which posts)
- user accounts (username and a hashed password, used for login and to attribute posts/comments/attendance to a specific user).

Use Case Tasks

1. Find an event on the board and view its details.
2. Create a new account (or log in), then create a new event post.
3. Mark yourself as attending (“I Am In”) an event and leave a comment asking a question about it.
4. Create an event

Experiment

7. Welcome the participants and thank them for their time.
8. Ask for permission to record audio, video, and screen for this session, for the sole purpose of improving the application.
9. Ask them to describe what they're looking at, what they expect to happen, and what confuses them, as they go through the process .
10. Remind them that they are not being evaluated the app is being evaluated
11. Ask the participant to imagine they are a person looking for something to do locally, or someone wanting to organize a small get-together

Experiment Notes

*After finishing running the experiment for each participant, make sure to write down right away all the notes you remember from the session. Then, **rewatch the session** video looking for parts on which the participants were frustrated or struggling to complete a task, and write notes for that. Using that information identifies issues, bugs and other points of improvements.*

Demographics questions

- What's your age?
- How often do you attend local/community events (never, rarely, monthly, weekly+)?
- Have you used an event-discovery app before (Meetup, Eventbrite, Facebook Events, etc.)? Which ones?
- How would you rate your general comfort with using new websites/apps (1–5)?

Recording setup

- Screen recording of the participant's browser (desktop or mobile, matching how they'd realistically use the app).
- Audio recording of the participant thinking out loud.
- Video of the participant's face/reactions, if they consent optional but useful for spotting frustration that isn't verbalized.
- Confirm recording has actually started before beginning the introduction script.

Script of the tasks (read to participants)

Before I give you any tasks, take a minute to just look at this page. What do you think this app is for?

Script for T1:

Imagine you're free this weekend and want to find something fun to do nearby. Use the app to find an event that interests you and open it to see more details.

Script for T2:

You'd like to organize a small get-together yourself. Create an account and login.

Script for T3:

You've decided you want to go to one of the events on the board. Let the organizer know you're coming.

Script for T4:

Post a new event with a title, description, date, and time.

Alex's Participants

Participant 1 (Emilie, 33, Property Manager) — Score/Notes card

Task	Usability Score, How Easy (1–5)	Notes
T1: Find an event on the board and view its details.	4	Clicked on event on board, but title mismatched in post detail page causing confusion
T2 Create a new account (or log in), then create a new event post.	5	No confirmation, not what she expected when logging in/signing up
T3: Mark yourself as attending (“I Am In”) an event	5	
T4 creating post	4	“Create Post” did not show up on button for submitting post likely due

		to Apple product. User struggled to confirm if post went through at first
Overall	18/20	

Participant 2 (Scott, 28, Student) — Score/Notes card

Task	Usability Score, How Easy (1–5)	Notes
T1: Find an event on the board and view its details.	4.5	Suggested icons at top to help increase visibility of the buttons. Also suggested distinguishing events in calendar view instead of having one large list
T2 Create a new account (or log in), then create a new event post.	4.5	“Pretty easy.” Thought there could be forgot username/password link
T3: Mark yourself as attending (“I Am In”) an event	4.5	User commented about having emojis available in when leaving comment
T4 create post	4	There’s no okay button (to confirm date or time after selection) or categories
Overall	17.5/20	

Participant 3 (Terry, 59, Professional) — Score/Notes card

Task	Usability Score, How Easy (1–5)	Notes
T1: Find an event on the board and view its details.	5	Mentioned colors up top kind of blend, but after using once, was very easy

		to navigate to find or submit new post
T2 Create a new account (or log in), then create a new event post.	4.5	“easy”
T3: Mark yourself as attending (“I Am In”) an event	5	“Super easy”
T4 creating post	5	“Create Post” was not showing in submit button leaving user confused after entering time and wasn’t sure if it submitted or completed as they didn’t realize they clicked on it on iphone
Overall	19.5/20	

Nat’s Participants

Participant 4 (Bernard, 64, Professional)— Score/Notes card

Task	Usability Score, How Easy (1–5)	Notes
T1: Find an event on the board and view its details.	5	Could add a drop down option to filter events.
T2 Create a new account (or log in), then create a new event post.	5	Straight forward, they like to see the password letters.
T3: Mark yourself as attending (“I Am In”) an event	5	Easy
T4 Create a post	4	Recommended to have drop down categories. Have the ability to make events re-occurring
Overall	19/20	

Participant 5 (Jenny, 64, Professional)— Score/Notes card

Task	Usability Score, How Easy (1–5)	Notes
T1: Find an event on the board and view its details.	5	Asked about how far the page would scroll, mentioned to set a limit? Recommended more descriptions of the event. and to add categories
T2 Create a new account (or log in), then create a new event post.	5	Easy
T3: Mark yourself as attending (“I Am In”) an event	5	Easy
T4 create post	4	Have it framed as a new event or propose an event. Ask for more sub details, and show them in the post.
Overall	19/20	

Participant 6— (Ella, 31, Fundraiser) Score/Notes card

Task	Usability Score, How Easy (1–5)	Notes
T1: Find an event on the board and view its details.	5	Easy
T2 Create a new account (or log in), then create a new event post.	4	Easy but a bit confusion with signup/login
T3: Mark yourself as attending (“I Am In”) an event	5	Easy

T4 creating post	4	Because it didnt work a 4
Overall	18/20	

Issue card

Category	Feedback
Issue #1	Events are all clustered together in one list. No filter or search available or calendar view to distinguish events
Change	Add search and/or filter by date or event type. Provide a calendar search feature or separate multiple lists based off dates as well (like Outlook)
Priority (Must, Could, Should, Would)	Could
How change should be implemented?	Add filters/search fix button and make it calendar searchable or distinguish events based off dates on separate lists.

Category	Feedback
Issue #2	"Create Post" button not discoverable on Apple products i.e. macbook and iphone
Change	Make the create-post control visible and reachable at every screen size
Priority (Must, Could, Should, Would)	Must
How change should be implemented?	Turn the create-post action into a persistent, clearly labeled button (e.g. a floating action or header button) that doesn't rely on the current top nav placement. Test it on multiple devices.

Category	Feedback
Issue #3	No confirmation shown after a post is successfully created
Change	Add a visible success message after submission
Priority (Must, Could, Should, Would)	Must
How change should be implemented?	Add a toast or notification message (e.g. "Post created!") on successful submission

Category	Feedback
Issue #4	No confirmation on login/signup
Change	Add clear feedback, toast, or some notification message on successful login or signup or how to recover login
Priority (Must, Could, Should, Would)	Must
How change should be implemented?	Show inline success/error text on the login and signup and add a forgot username and password link that starts login recovery

Category	Feedback
Issue #5	Clicking a post sometimes opens details that don't match the post that was clicked, possibly on Apple products
Change	Fix the mismatch between the board list and the post detail view
Priority (Must, Could, Should, Would)	Must

How change should be implemented?	Check how post IDs are passed from the board list to the detail route/component and test
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Category	Feedback
Issue #6	Top navigation is small, low-contrast, and/or hard to notice
Change	Redesign the top nav for visibility and simplicity
Priority (Must, Could, Should, Would)	Could
How change should be implemented?	Increase nav button sizes and contrast or replace buttons with a dropdown or hamburger menu or icons to help increase visibility

Category	Feedback
Issue #7	No emoji support when creating a post
Change	Add some emojis to the post form
Priority (Must, Could, Should, Would)	Could
How change should be implemented?	Integrate an emoji library into the post creation form's text field

Category	Feedback
Issue #8	Mentioned lack of description of events, besides header, recommended to include tags below.
Change	Include more description fields, in tags.

Priority (Must, Could, Should, Would)	Must
How change should be implemented?	Add tags in sub header of post